

Although Myron had been consistent in his references to the craft being bell-shaped, I asked him, for the record, about the object being described to look like an acorn in the *Unsolved Mysteries* documentary. He agreed that either description would be appropriate.

The Second Witness

When I first called Myron's cousin, JS, October 3, 1990, for his recollection of their experience, he was less informative. While cordial, he was reluctant to get involved, understandably, for family reasons. However, he did confirm that he and Myron delivered glazed bricks to the Air Base, remembers the "guards wearing protective clothing," and being a former welder himself, asking one of the technicians with a blow torch, "What are you cutting?" The reply, he recalls, "I can't discuss that." When I asked if he had seen the craft in the building, he said, "I don't remember many details on that trip," adding, "My partner probably knows more because he was more inquisitive."

But, the reserved posture of JS changed. When I called Myron again, March 29, 1991, to clarify details in relation to the bell-shaped object's size, I was told that his cousin was now willing to discuss his own observations.

I called JS, March 30, and again April 1, 1991 for additional details and, yes, he did *see the object the day before* he and his cousin went to the Wright-Patterson AFB property together with brick loads. He had made the trip alone with the first load of bricks and recalls clearly seeing the object, shaped like a *liberty bell* under its tarp sitting upright aboard the lowboy trailer. Without hesitation, JS estimated the object's size was 8 to 10 ft. tall and 8 to 10 ft. wide. No, he could not recall if the trailer was Army or Air Force. "I'm the kind of person who minds his own business," he said, "I didn't ask any questions but it probably arrived a short time before I did."

JS went on to say, "There was activity in the area, men wearing fatigue suits and there were armed guards, but I didn't see anyone carrying a machine gun. "Unlike the next day's trip, there was nothing unusual at the entrance gate. I gave the guard my identification and showed him my bill of lading and was directed to the area for unloading near the big red brick building."

"Being formerly a welder," said JS, "The next day I recall asking one of the workmen wearing a head shield outside the building, "What are you cutting?" He said he couldn't discuss it. That was it for me."

For the record, I asked JS for a more definitive description of the special brick. He said "It was a red glazed, moisture-resistant *jumbo* sized brick, approximately 4 by 12 or more inches."

Still more evidence of the Kecksburg connection came to Myron's attention shortly after the event from alert truckers with CB radios who normally monitor traffic on the highways. Anything unusual is shared. And, so it happened, they spotted the truck and trailer and its strange cargo -- and jeep escort -- journey from the Pittsburgh area going West on Route 40 toward Wheeling, then to Lockbourne AFB in Columbus for a brief layover, then on to Dayton.

As Stan Gordon points out, the origin of the Kecksburg UFO has not been determined. It may or may not be extraterrestrial, but the facts show that it was a structured craft, resistant to "our" known high-tech means to get inside .

ANOTHER "ACORN": ITS CRASH/RETRIEVAL NEAR EDWARDS AFB, 1971

Earlier I made reference to a case of a UFO landing at Edwards AFB which was recorded on movie film by an Air Force officer (and his crew), who later became an astronaut. Without knowing that UFO's fate, or perhaps of others we never heard about at the base, we now have a report that "something" landed, or crash-landed in 1971 just 15 miles outside of its vast property, near the small town of California City. This incident surfaced from a firsthand

witness, Debbie Clayton, who felt obliged to report her experience after watching the rerun of the Kecksburg UFO crash on *Unsolved Mysteries*. When I talked with Debby by phone after getting her name from Stan Gordon, she said she thought the craft depicted on the show, described as an acorn shape, looked similar to the object she had seen except that hers was like a mushroom at the top. Her letter recounting her experience, follows:

Since last talking with you, I gathered more information. I called my old girlfriend's ex and he said that she remembered the incident occurring in the summer of 1971 because they hadn't moved to our area until winter of 1970. So, I was incorrect about the date.

It was late afternoon, but it was still daylight when we (my girlfriend's family and I) heard a loud, roaring noise similar to the roaring of a plane warming up. Then, we heard the crashing sound and went outside to see what happened. We found a cloud of dust three blocks in front of us. Since there were only six homes in our neighborhood, it was easy to spot.

My friend's older brother grabbed his father's camera and we walked to the crash-site. An elementary school's mobile classrooms are now where the craft was but at the time I believe there was a small baseball field near it.

A few other neighbors had arrived and we were all speculating on it being an Air Force "toy" that had gotten out of control. An Air Force car and one truck arrived within 15 minutes. The truck had about five men in it with rifles. An officer got out of the car and told his men to move us back away from the craft. He saw that Dalton, my friend's brother, was taking pictures and grabbed the camera, threw it to the ground and broke it. (He never tried to remove the film.) Dalton yelled and argued with the officer but we were told to leave, ignoring Dalton and his threats. About that time, other trucks arrived, one with men aboard; another with a trailer on the back and a third one with a small crane.

The officer told us that we had to leave or be arrested. But we moved only across the street at first. We watched while the men attached a large canvas to the craft and lift it by attaching cables to metal hooks that were on the canvas. After the craft was loaded, they all left. There was no mention of the incident in the newspapers.

As for the craft itself, we searched for markings but found only some old scratches that we could not read. Because it was upright, we couldn't see the bottom. There were no windows or seams, appearing to be made from a one-piece mold. If I remember correctly, it was a dark grayish color with greenish highlights -- not a color one normally sees. The texture was quite smooth. There was a mild heat coming from the craft somewhat like a car engine after traveling for an hour. One more thing I thought was strange; there was no dust that clung to the shell. Here, in the desert, dust is everywhere and clings to everything.

Because we were only 15 miles from Edwards's AFB and the speed in which the first car and truck arrived, I believe the craft was being tracked and they knew exactly where to find it. Also, I believe that when the officer broke Dalton's camera, it was to draw attention to himself instead of the craft. Otherwise, he could have taken the camera...The size of the craft...5 feet high and 10 feet wide -- are estimates from a fourteen year old's memories, but I think they are pretty close.

My follow up phone call to Debby revealed a few more details. She recalled that the object appeared to fall straight down from the sky and that it was not a speedy descent and that it landed (or crashed) in a perfect upright position -- no tilt. She also recalled that the tumbleweeds surrounding the object appeared to be darkened as if burnt or singed, but she saw no fire. And, she clearly recalls the soldiers busily shoveling soil at the site and the next day there was no trace of a depression caused by the craft. I asked about physical effects. Only Dalton complained, she said, and described the terrible pain he endured later that night in his arm from wrist to elbow. My guess here is that the culprit was the officer who got carried away in grabbing the camera. No wonder Dalton "yelled and argued" as Debby explained in her letter.

But, the real mystery is the object's identity. A U.S. secret "toy" as Debby speculated, or another errant craft similar to the one that descended into Kecksburg in 1965? There are parallels; except in the Edwards' incident, there were no signs of radiation and no protective clothing observed to be worn by the retrievers. Also, there was no ambulance on the scene in event of